

Europe's first solar flowers?

The Government's claims about Gozo's fifteen solar flowers, tested against the record

THE CLAIM

“With the installation of these first solar flowers in Europe, we are demonstrating ...”

Clint Camilleri, Minister for Gozo and Planning, 21 October 2025

Lovin Malta's English (tagged “Press Release”); Maltese original in TVM News. The Commission's page repeats the claim.

He added the energy would supply the Park and Ride's electric buses.

VERDICT

CONTRADICTED

Installed elsewhere in Europe from 2015.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

2016

In service in Austria by 2016

Motorway operator ASFINAG put a SmartFlower into service at a rest area on the A21.

15

SmartFlowers installed

The maker calls Gozo's “one of the largest installations in Europe”, not the first.

≈85 MWh

Modelled output a year

PVGIS, if 2.5 kWp each (capacity not published). No metered output published.

36.5%

Tracking gain, modelled

More energy than fixed panels at the site in PVGIS, against “up to 40%” claimed.

None

Bus-charging figures published

The share covered cannot be calculated. Parliament was told no feasibility study was made (Newsbook, second-hand).

FAIR TO SAY

The flowers were EU-funded (about €850,000). Parliament was told they work and are Malta's first (Newsbook, second-hand). A claim to be among Europe's largest would have held.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ What “first of its kind in Europe” meant.

☐ The flowers' capacity and metered output.

☐ The shuttle buses' charging energy and hours.

☐ How the flowers are wired to the chargers.